



COLBY JOHNSON, shown in front of his tent on Skid Row, says “a lot of the homeless out here don’t know what’s happening out here for funding.” An audit ordered by U.S. District Judge David O. Carter found the city was unable to precisely track spending and assess services.

GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

Audit faults homeless services oversight

The court-ordered survey points out ‘deadly’ holes in L.A.’s programs.

By DOUG SMITH

Homeless services provided by the city of Los Angeles and the Los Angeles Homeless Services Authority are disjointed and lack adequate data systems and financial controls to monitor contracts for compliance and performance, leaving the system vulnerable to waste and fraud, an audit ordered by a federal judge has concluded.

The audit by the global consulting firm Alvarez and Marsal found that the city was unable to track exactly how much it spent on homeless programs and did not rigorously reconcile spending with services provided, making it impossible to judge how well the services worked or whether they were even provided.

Contracts written by [See Audit, A6]

Energy focus may target protected lands

Conservation groups concerned as Trump’s Interior secretary eyes national monuments.

By LILA SEIDMAN

Interior Secretary Doug Burgum has directed his staff to review and possibly alter national monuments as part of a push to expand U.S. energy production, a move that could further shake up public lands amid mass firings of national park and forest employees.

Conservationists fear that cherished landscapes — including two newly minted California monuments — will be

stripped of protections for significant cultural and ecological resources. But conservatives have argued that public lands should remain open to oil drilling and coal mining, among other uses.

In a Feb. 3 order, Burgum directed his assistant secretaries to “review and, as appropriate, revise all withdrawn public lands,” citing a federal statute corresponding to the 1906 law that allows presidents to create national monuments.

The directive was part of a sweeping secretarial order, called “Unleashing American Energy,” that seeks to boost resource extraction on federal land and water. Burgum gave agency officials 15 days to submit plans on how

[See Burgum, A8]



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

PRESIDENT BIDEN established the Chuckwalla National Monument, protecting more than 600,000 acres of public lands in the rugged California desert.

Hackman, wife died days apart, officials say

Actor had heart disease, spouse had virus, findings show.

By NATHAN SOLIS

The seemingly mysterious deaths of Gene Hackman and his wife, Betsy Arakawa, in their Santa Fe, N.M., home were both natural and occurred days apart before they were discovered, authorities announced Friday.

Hackman, 95, had heart disease and Alzheimer’s disease and probably died days after his 65-year-old wife, [See Hackman, A4]

Feeling threatened in U.S., trans citizens look abroad

Many consider fleeing as their protections and rights are curbed. Some already have.

By KEVIN RECTOR

Alexia Nunez presumed “things were going to be pretty bad” for transgender people under President

Trump, given his campaign rhetoric, but had decided to stick it out in the U.S. “as long as possible.”

Her breaking point came just days after Trump’s inauguration, she said, when Secretary of State Marco Rubio ordered the suspension of passport applications seeking a gender marker different from an applicant’s birth sex.

Nunez, a 46-year-old soft-

ware engineer originally from San Diego, called the directive the “definition of discrimination against a marginalized community,” and a direct threat to her safety as a transgender woman.

Although her passport has reflected her female identity since 2016, it expires next year. Suddenly, she feared renewing it would leave her without a travel

document that matched her identity and appearance, and without a means of fleeing the country if things in the U.S. grew increasingly hostile.

“I knew it was time to enact my emergency plan,” Nunez said.

Transgender Americans and their families are reaching similar conclusions across the country amid numerous anti-transgender

policies from the Trump administration. They include directives to defund or even criminalize gender-affirming medical care, punish teachers who support gender nonconforming kids at school, ban transgender people from bathrooms and sports teams, and cast doubt not only on their legal documents but their very existence.

[See Transgender, A5]

COLUMN ONE

From udder to cup, ‘boozy latte’ is a cherished secret



DANIA MAXWELL Los Angeles Times

A COW is milked for pajarete, a breakfast drink favored by ranchers in western Mexico. Despite risks, raw milk consumption in the U.S. is rising.

Some savor the frothy concoction of milk and alcohol. But is it safe?

By DANIEL HERNANDEZ

The goat had a resigned look in her eyes as the rancher pressed her udder and aimed a stream of milk into a tall cup. Sunrise needled through the misty air. The smell of manure was almost tactile. A foam emerged as the shooting milk churned with a powdery mixture at the cup’s bottom: instant coffee, granulated sugar, cinnamon and a hefty shot of alcohol de caña, an imported cane liquor that is

nearly pure alcohol. The froth reached the top of the cup, creating a crown of tan bubbles.

This is how you make a pajarete, a rustic drink from western Mexico. The term comes from the root *pájaro*, or bird, which is to say, according to ranchers, it gives you a lift. The pajarate (pah-HA-re-teh) is offered like this on early mornings in various agricultural pockets of Southern California. The practice is covert, unlicensed and unregulated, one of those “if you know, you know” social

[See Drink, A10]

U.S. courts Iran on nuclear deal

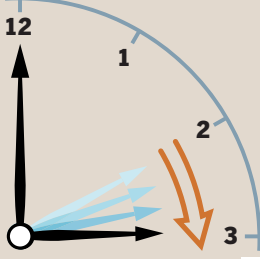
President Trump says he has sent a letter to supreme leader, who didn’t immediately respond. **WORLD, A3**

States sue over education cuts

California is among eight fighting Trump Cabinet’s plan to slash millions from training pipeline. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Timely reminder

Daylight saving time begins Sunday at 2 a.m.



Weather

Sunshine. L.A. Basin: 70/46. **B8**



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